UNION TERRITORIES

RATIONALE, EVOLUTION AND THE → PART VIII CONSTITUTIONAL MAP → ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT → HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE → DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN → DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation gfj and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

RATIONALE, EVOLUTION AND THE CURRENT EIGHT

RATIONALE, EVOLUTION AND THE CURRENT EIGHT · WHY UTS EXIST · UNION RESPONSIBILITY + DIFFERENTIATED LOCAL DEMOCRACY. · PART C/D ARRANGEMENTS · 7TH AMENDMENT AND 1956 REORGANISATION · MODERN UT CATEGORY. · J&K AND LADAKH CREATED · 26 JAN 2020

WHY UTS EXIST → Union responsibility + differentiated local democracy. → Part C/D arrangements → 7th Amendment and 1956 reorganisation → modern UT category. → 2019: J&K and Ladakh created → 26 Jan 2020: DNH and DD merged.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- WHY UTS EXIST
- Union responsibility + differentiated local democracy.
- Part C/D arrangements → 7th Amendment and 1956 reorganisation → modern UT category.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 2019: J&K and Ladakh created
- 26 Jan 2020: DNH and DD merged.
- CURRENT EIGHT

CHECK / LIMIT
- WITH LEGISLATURE: Delhi, Puducherry, J&K
- WITHOUT: the other five.
- MUST REMEMBER: Separate Articles 239, 239A, 239AA, 239AB, 239B, 240, 241 and 246(4).

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- then distinguish direct administration, statutory legislatures and Delhi's constitutionally entrenched NCT model.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Separate Articles 239, 239A, 239AA, 239AB, 239B, 240, 241 and 246(4), then distinguish direct administration, statutory legislatures and Delhi's constitutionally entrenched NCT model.

01

STAGE 01

PART VIII CONSTITUTIONAL MAP

PART VIII CONSTITUTIONAL MAP · ARTICLE MAP · 239 ADMINISTRATION THROUGH PRESIDENT-APPOINTED ADMINISTRATOR. · 239A PUDUCHERRY LEGISLATURE/COM ENABLING POWER · 239B ORDINANCE ROUTE. · 239AA DELHI NCT SCHEME · 239AB DELHI FAILURE-OF-MACHINERY ROUTE. · 240 PRESIDENTIAL REGULATIONS

ARTICLE MAP

239 administration through President-appointed Administrator. → 239A Puducherry legislature/CoM enabling power → 239B ordinance route.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE MAP
- 239 administration through President-appointed Administrator.
- 239A Puducherry legislature/CoM enabling power

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 239B ordinance route.
- 239AA Delhi NCT scheme
- 239AB Delhi failure-of-machinery route.

CHECK / LIMIT
- 240 presidential regulations
- 241 High Courts.
- 246(4): Parliament may legislate on every list for territory outside a State.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CORE RULE
- A local UT legislature never removes Parliament's continuing competence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A local UT legislature never removes Parliament's continuing competence.

02

STAGE 02

ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT RULE

ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT RULE · UT ADMINISTRATION · THE ADMINISTRATOR IS THE PRESIDENT'S AGENT, NOT A PART · A STATE GOVERNOR ACTING AS ADJOINING-UT ADMINISTRATOR ACTS INDEPENDENTLY · THREE MODELS · DIRECT ADMINISTRATION · STATUTORY LEGISLATURE · DELHI'S CONSTITUTIONAL NCT DESIGN.

PRESIDENT → ADMINISTRATOR/LG → UT ADMINISTRATION → The Administrator is the President's agent, not a Part VI Governor. → A State Governor acting as adjoining-UT Administrator acts independently of the State CoM. → THREE MODELS → Direct administration

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PRESIDENT → ADMINISTRATOR/LG → UT ADMINISTRATION
- The Administrator is the President's agent, not a Part VI Governor.
- A State Governor acting as adjoining-UT Administrator acts independently of the State CoM.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- THREE MODELS
- Direct administration
- statutory legislature

CHECK / LIMIT
- Delhi's constitutional NCT design.
- ARTICLE 240
- Specified-territory regulations have the force of an Act of Parliament.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- THREE MODELS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Specified-territory regulations have the force of an Act of Parliament.

03

STAGE 03

HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE UTS

HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE UTS · HIGH COURT MAP · DELHI HC · J&K + LADAKH · COMMON J&K AND LADAKH HC. · PUNJAB & HARYANA · WITHOUT LEGISLATURE · DIRECT UNION ADMINISTRATION STILL COEXISTS WITH MPS, COURTS, LOCAL

HIGH COURT MAP

Delhi → Delhi HC · J&K + Ladakh → common J&K and Ladakh HC. · A&N → Calcutta

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- HIGH COURT MAP
- Delhi → Delhi HC
- J&K + Ladakh → common J&K and Ladakh HC.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- A&N → Calcutta
- Chandigarh → Punjab & Haryana
- DNHDD → Bombay.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Lakshadweep → Kerala
- Puducherry → Madras.
- WITHOUT LEGISLATURE

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Direct Union administration still coexists with MPs, courts, local bodies and legal remedies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Direct Union administration still coexists with MPs, courts, local bodies and legal remedies.

04

STAGE 04

DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN

DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN · DELHI NCT · 69TH AMENDMENT 1991 · ARTICLE 239AA · ASSEMBLY + COM + LG. · ASSEMBLY FIELD · STATE AND CONCURRENT LISTS EXCEPT ENTRIES 1, 2 AND · RESERVED CORE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
DELHI NCT	ASSEMBLY FIELD	Reserved core: public order	LG reference to President is exceptional, not routine.
69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.	State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.	Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.	Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- DELHI NCT
- 69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ASSEMBLY FIELD
- State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Reserved core: public order
- Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LG reference to President is exceptional, not routine.
- Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.

05

STAGE 05

DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE

DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE · GNCTD AID-AND-ADVICE JUDGMENT (2018) · REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT AND AID/ADVICE PREVAIL WITHIN DELHI'S ALLOTTED FIELD. · DELHI SERVICES JUDGMENT (2023) — 11 MAY · ENTRY 41 SERVICES FOLLOWED ELECTED ACCOUNTABILITY OUTSIDE THE RESERVED · ACT 19 OF 2023 · NCCSA RECOMMENDS TRANSFERS/POSTINGS; LG HAS STATUTORY FINAL SAY ON · 28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL

GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018) → Representative government and aid/advice prevail within Delhi's allotted field. → Delhi services judgment (2023) — 11 MAY → Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields. → ACT 19 OF 2023

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018)
- Representative government and aid/advice prevail within Delhi's allotted field.
- Delhi services judgment (2023) — 11 MAY

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields.
- ACT 19 OF 2023
- NCCSA recommends transfers/postings; LG has statutory final say on disagreement.

CHECK / LIMIT
- 28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL
- The Act remains operative; pending constitutional challenge is not invalidation.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Delhi excludes State List Entries 1, 2 and 18 plus related 64-66

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- J&K excludes public order and police
- Puducherry's statutory competence is over List II/III matters insofar as applicable to Union Territories.
- Parliament retains overriding UT competence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Delhi excludes State List Entries 1, 2 and 18 plus related 64-66; J&K excludes public order and police; Puducherry's statutory competence is over List II/III matters insofar as applicable to Union Territories. Parliament retains overriding UT competence.

06

STAGE 06

PUDUCHERRY STATUTORY MODEL

PUDUCHERRY STATUTORY MODEL · ARTICLE 239A + GOVERNMENT OF UNION TERRITORIES ACT 1963 · STATUTORY ASSEMBLY + COM; PARLIAMENT RETAINS UT-WIDE POWER. · ARTICLE 239B ORDINANCE REQUIRES PRIOR PRESIDENTIAL INSTRUCTIONS · K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018) · CENTRAL NOMINATION OF UP TO THREE MEMBERS UPHELD; NOMINEES · ARTICLE 240 · REGULATION POWER IS UNAVAILABLE DURING NORMAL ASSEMBLY FUNCTIONING.

ARTICLE 239A + GOVERNMENT OF UNION TERRITORIES ACT 1963

Statutory Assembly + CoM; Parliament retains UT-wide power. → Article 239B ordinance requires prior presidential instructions. → K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 239A + GOVERNMENT OF UNION TERRITORIES ACT 1963
- Statutory Assembly + CoM; Parliament retains UT-wide power.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Article 239B ordinance requires prior presidential instructions.
- K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018)

CHECK / LIMIT
- Central nomination of up to three members upheld; nominees possess voting rights.
- ARTICLE 240

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Regulation power is unavailable during normal Assembly functioning.
- It revives during constitutionally qualifying suspension or dissolution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: It revives during constitutionally qualifying suspension or dissolution.

07

STAGE 07

JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019

JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019 · J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER · UT WITH LEGISLATURE · UT WITHOUT LEGISLATURE. · J&K ASSEMBLY · STATE/CONCURRENT COMPETENCE EXCEPT PUBLIC ORDER AND POLICE; LAND IS · BUDGET, LEGISLATION AND EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY OPERATE UNDER THE ACT · ELECTED ASSEMBLY AND COM FUNCTION AFTER 2024; STATEHOOD NOT

J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER → J&K → UT with legislature → Ladakh → UT without legislature. → J&K ASSEMBLY → State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER
- J&K → UT with legislature

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Ladakh → UT without legislature.
- J&K ASSEMBLY

CHECK / LIMIT
- State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded.
- Budget, legislation and executive accountability operate under the Act and rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Elected Assembly and CoM function after 2024; Statehood not restored by 5 Sep 2026.
- Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.

08

STAGE 08

DELHI, PUDUCHERRY AND J&K COMPARED

DELHI, PUDUCHERRY AND J&K COMPARED · CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLE 239AA · EXCLUDES PUBLIC ORDER, POLICE, LAND. · ARTICLE 239A + 1963 ACT · LIST II/III MATTERS INSOFAR AS APPLICABLE TO UTS. · 2019 ACT + ARTICLE 239A APPLICATION · EXCLUDES PUBLIC ORDER AND POLICE. · ALL THREE

DELHI	constitutional Article 239AA	excludes public order, police, land.
PUDUCHERRY	Article 239A + 1963 Act	List II/III matters insofar as applicable to UTs.
J&K	2019 Act + Article 239A application	excludes public order and police.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- constitutional Article 239AA
- excludes public order, police, land.
- Article 239A + 1963 Act

POWER / PROCEDURE
- List II/III matters insofar as applicable to UTs.
- 2019 Act + Article 239A application
- excludes public order and police.

CHECK / LIMIT
- ALL THREE
- Assembly + CoM + Administrator/LG; Parliament retains overriding UT competence.
- DO NOT FLATTEN

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Legal source, nominated membership, services control and referral rules differ.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Legal source, nominated membership, services control and referral rules differ.

09

STAGE 09

FRICTION, ACCOUNTABILITY AND REFORM

FRICTION, ACCOUNTABILITY AND REFORM · WHY FRICTION OCCURS · SPLIT LEGISLATIVE FIELD + DIVIDED OFFICER CONTROL + REFERRAL/OVERRIDE · ACCOUNTABILITY TEST · EXACT FIELD · COURT REMEDY. · CLARIFY RESERVED FIELDS · BOUND REFERRALS

WHY FRICTION OCCURS → Split legislative field + divided officer control + referral/override powers. → ACCOUNTABILITY TEST → Exact field → decision-maker → staff/finance → override → court remedy. → Clarify reserved fields

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- WHY FRICTION OCCURS
- Split legislative field + divided officer control + referral/override powers.
- ACCOUNTABILITY TEST

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Exact field → decision-maker → staff/finance → override → court remedy.
- Clarify reserved fields
- bound referrals.

CHECK / LIMIT
- align officers with accountability.
- Publish reasons and timelines
- preserve judicial review

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- date every current claim.
- Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

10

STAGE 10

PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS

PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS · PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11 · ARTICLE 239AA · 2018 RATIO · SERVICES SEQUEL · OPERATIVE 2023 ACT · PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4 · 2019 ACT

PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11

Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict. → PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4 → 2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood caveat.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11
- Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.
- PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood caveat.
- CASE CONTROLS
- GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018).

CHECK / LIMIT
- Delhi services judgment (2023).
- K. Lakshminarayanan (2018).
- In Re: Article 370 of the Constitution (2023).

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 239AB != 239B
- Chandigarh not Article 240-listed
- Delhi exclusions != J&K exclusions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.

11

STAGE 11

EXAM ANSWER SPINE AND CURRENT FIREWALL

EXAM ANSWER SPINE AND CURRENT FIREWALL · ANSWER SPINE · CLASSIFY MODEL · EXACT ARTICLE/STATUTE · LOCAL DEMOCRATIC MECHANISM. · ADD UNION SAFEGUARD · INSTITUTIONAL FRICTION · CALIBRATED REFORM.

ANSWER SPINE → Classify model → exact Article/statute → local democratic mechanism. → Add Union safeguard → institutional friction → case/year → calibrated reform. → EVIDENCE METHOD → Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ANSWER SPINE
- Classify model → exact Article/statute → local democratic mechanism.
- Add Union safeguard → institutional friction → case/year → calibrated reform.
- EVIDENCE METHOD
- Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- CURRENT FIREWALL — 28 AUGUST 2026
- 8 UTs
- 3 legislatures
- J&K elected but still UT.
- GNCTD Act 2023 operative

CHECK / LIMIT
- challenge unresolved
- proposal is not law.
- A UT legislature is real self-government, but not State-equivalent autonomy.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: India has eight Union Territories and three legislatures: Delhi,
- Puducherry and J&K.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- J&K has an elected government but remains a UT
- Ladakh has no legislature.
- Act 19 of 2023 remains operative while the Delhi services constitutional challenge is unresolved.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PART A — CREATION & LIST · PART B — ADMINISTRATION (ART 239–241) · PART C — SPECIAL STATUS OF DELHI (ART 239-AA) · J&K AND LADAKH CREATED 2019 BY THE J&K REORGANISATION · DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU MERGED · TOTAL DROPPED FROM 9 TO · CURRENT 8

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- PART A — CREATION & LIST
- PART B — ADMINISTRATION (Art 239–241)
- PART C — SPECIAL STATUS OF DELHI (Art 239-AA)
- J&K and Ladakh created 2019 by the J&K Reorganisation Act (J&K with legislature, Ladakh

ADVANCED LIMIT
- Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu merged into a single UT on 26 Jan 2020 → total dropped from 9 to
- Current 8: A&N Islands · Chandigarh · DNH & Daman & Diu · Delhi (NCT) · J&K · Ladakh · Lakshadweep ·
- LG: Delhi, Puducherry; A&N, J&K; Ladakh; Administrator: Chandigarh, DNH-DD; Lakshadweep.
- President may appoint a state Governor as administrator of an adjoining UT (acts independently of his

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- CM appointed by the President (not the LG); ministers hold office during President's pleasure.
- On a difference between LG and ministers, the LG refers the matter to the President .
- President's Rule provision resembles Art 356 .
- SC (May 2023): the elected Delhi government has control over services (admin control over officers),

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels